Dr. Sarah Hensley: Coaching Philosophy, FAQs & Free Training Overview

Compiled strictly from verified public FAQ and Free Webinar pages on doctorsarahhensley.com

1. Attachment Assessment vs. Online Quizzes

Online attachment quizzes are not credible and offer no scientific validity around proper attachment style assessment. Instead, Dr. Sarah Hensley and her assistant coaches use a modified version of the Adult Attachment Interview (AAI) to determine a client's attachment style, measuring individual nuances that allow the assessment to be much more accurate.

2. Coaching vs. Traditional Talk Therapy

Traditional therapy is often open-ended, guiding individuals through self-reflection to gain insight and awareness around past wounds and experiences. Attachment coaching with Dr. Hensley and her team is prescriptive and forward-focused: coaches set specific goals, practical strategies, and direct feedback to change ongoing relational behaviors resulting from past wounds—helping clients implement new behaviors rather than spending years solely processing the past.

3. Why Behavioral Coaching Works for Dismissive Avoidants

For many dismissive avoidants, traditional talk therapy can unintentionally trigger the defenses that keep them stuck—being asked to immediately access vulnerable emotions or examine painful patterns can lead to defensiveness, withdrawal, or emotional shutdown. Dr. Hensley's approach is strategic, prescriptive, and skill-based: rather than relying primarily on open-ended emotion talk, clients learn practical tools and concrete behaviors that provide a clear roadmap for growth while gradually building emotional capacity for deeper relationship work.

4. Healing Timelines & Non-Linear Growth

The timeline for change in oneself or a partner depends on self-awareness, commitment to practicing new tools, and the depth of underlying attachment wounds. Healing is never linear, and setbacks are a natural part of the process; consistent effort and self-compassion are essential on the path toward earned secure attachment.

5. When One Partner Isn't Ready to Join

Dr. Hensley recommends beginning the work even if a partner is not ready yet. Because relationship patterns operate as a system, shifting your own nervous system regulation and modeling secure behaviors changes the relational dynamic first, making it much easier for a partner to eventually mirror healthier, more secure responses. Couples enrolled in groups also do not have to attend the same cohort session.

6. Comparing Dr. Hensley's Style and Coach Elizabeth Pomeroy's Style

Both Dr. Hensley and Coach Elizabeth Pomeroy teach the same science-backed attachment framework, differing primarily in background, coaching style, and depth of exploration:

- Dr. Sarah Hensley (Ph.D., Experimental / Social & Health Psychology): Over 20 years of research and coaching expertise; often more direct and insight-oriented, helping participants uncover deeper wounds, subconscious patterns, and nervous system responses through real-time attunement.
- Coach Elizabeth Pomeroy, M.A. (Master's Degree in Counseling): Warm, gentle, supportive, and compassionate style teaching the same secure relationship principles and neuroscience-backed skills.

7. ADHD vs. Fearful-Avoidant Attachment & CPTSD

There is an observed correlation between Fearful-Avoidant attachment and ADHD-like symptoms stemming from Complex PTSD (CPTSD), though ADHD itself is a separate issue from attachment. When ADHD is present in a relationship, mutual partner education and understanding of ADHD are essential alongside attachment work.

8. Self-Paced Education vs. Live Coaching & Why 1:1s Are Exclusive

Self-paced coursework provides lifelong access to foundational education, tools, and frameworks, while Hybrid Group programs add live coaching calls, community accountability, real-time attunement, and Q&A tailored to your situation. Because Dr. Hensley's mission is to reach and teach as many people as possible to love securely—and 1:1 sessions require extensive individual time—her 1:1 availability is kept exclusive so she can devote greater capacity to live group coaching.

9. Free Webinar: 'The Hidden System Shaping Your Love Life (And How to Master It!)'

Hosted by Dr. Sarah Hensley, this 45-minute free training has reached 10,000+ men and women worldwide and focuses on helping attendees stop repeating painful relationship cycles through three core takeaways:

- 01 Identify why your love life has felt painful and name the hidden patterns running your relationships.
- 02 Understand the emotional triggers and subconscious attachment dynamics keeping you stuck.
- 03 Learn a 3-part framework and clear action plan to build healthy, lasting secure connection.